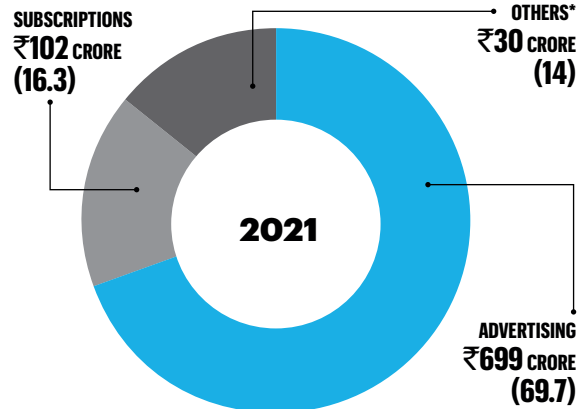
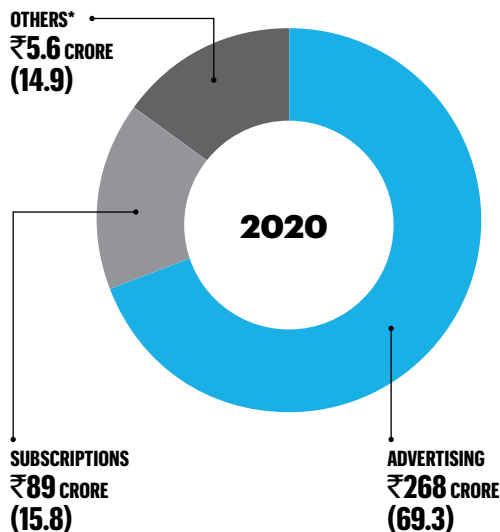


REVENUE STREAMS

Advertising accounts for a major share of Truecaller's revenue globally



AS PER THE EXCHANGE RATE ON OCTOBER 7, 2022; FIGURES IN BRACKETS ARE FOR PERCENTAGE OF TOTAL REVENUE; *INCLUDES REVENUES FROM TRUECALLER FOR BUSINESS AND PARTNERS; **SOURCE** COMPANY

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THE COST OF CONVENIENCE

To access Truecaller's caller ID features and other app functions, one has to give access to one's contact list, including details of people who have not downloaded the app and given consent to have their numbers identified. To this, Jhunjhunwala says that even if someone is not a Truecaller user, they can remove their data. Rather than a delisting feature, this should be a voluntary joining feature, experts point out. "We don't hide that fact at all. You will find how to delist your number on our website. We have also applied control mechanisms that users have on their data. There are terms of service which people say yes to. That's not something we wanted to hide behind," he adds.

He further says that Truecaller doesn't show the full terms of service upfront but a neatly formatted summary written in plain English, and not in legal gobbledegook, so that everybody can understand it. "Then, if you want that legal document, you have access to the full terms of service," he adds. Duggal, meanwhile, says that even in that legal document, nobody explicitly

gives the consent to monetise their data. "Merely because someone is ignorant of the law, does not mean that they should be made a victim. If there's more awareness, people will prefer to not use apps like Truecaller," he adds.

Dubey, however, isn't oblivious of the other side of the coin. "Yes, they're profiling users without their consent but it's also debatable. If someone is calling them, they have all the right to know who is calling. An app like that also has a lot of advantages for its users," he says.

Duggal disagrees. "Yes, it's convenient to know who's calling but that doesn't mean they have the right to put someone's number on a public platform," he says. Experts are banking on the new data protection law in the upcoming budget session to address some of these issues as a starting point. Although users get the convenience of caller detection and spam recognition, it comes at the cost of digital profiling and a potential data breach. The ball is now in the government's court to turn it into a fair playing ground. **BT**

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